

# The Pros and Cons Of E-Books

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**I**t was in 2012 that the electronic book, or e-book, made its foray into the Indian market. Amazon introduced its reading device Kindle in India a few years after its launch in the US in November 2007. But the origin goes back much further. The wave of the e-book was first initiated by Project Gutenberg founder Michael S. Hart, who created the first ever e-book in 1971.

However, the years that followed did not witness any dramatic transition in reading habits of the readers. In India, too, e-books failed to stir the enthusiasm of readers instantly, when these were launched. The concept was viewed with scepticism as readers

considered physical books to be better for an immersive reading. They felt an acute vacuum in e-books—the smell of paper and feel of reading real books.

Interestingly, the scenario of e-books has changed over the years, slowly and steadily, in India. With an explosive growth of smartphones, tablets and reading apps, there has been an overall surge in the consumption of digital content. According to industry estimates, e-books account for five per cent of overall book sales in the country.

Although e-books are yet to create a firmer space in the publishing market, they are witnessing growth. On an optimistic note, major publishers and

